

 MEITY GENESIS EIR SCHEME • COHORT 3

FOUNDLY

“Beyond Followers. Beyond Connections.”

An AI-enabled social platform where creators showcase verified work, AI generates structured skill insights, and opportunity providers discover talent based on ability rather than popularity or networks.

Founder: Vedagya Sharma | **Stage:** Early-Stage Prototype (TRL-3) | **Focus:** AI-Assisted Skill Intelligence

| The Talent Discovery Gap

The Visibility Paradox

Digital talent discovery is heavily dictated by algorithmic virality, subscriber vanity metrics, and geography. In Tier-2/3 cities and university campuses across India, thousands of gifted coders, musicians, and designers possess exceptional skill but remain virtually invisible because they lack social followings.

Current internet signal: “Who follows you” and “Who knows you.”

The Opportunity Blindspot

Startups, creative agencies, and production studios waste hundreds of hours filtering through superficial follower counts and inflated portfolios. High popularity does not guarantee technical or artistic excellence, causing organizations to repeatedly miss exceptional, unnetworked talent.

Proposed Foundly signal: “What can you actually demonstrate and do?”

| The Broken Discovery Model

90%+

Capable Talent Overlooked

Due to zero social capital & network barriers

Followers Should Not Be Gatekeepers

Conventional social algorithms prioritize high-frequency entertainment and engagement loops over demonstrated craftsmanship. An aspiring vocal artist or systems architect with 300 followers receives practically zero algorithmic distribution.

Foundly is built on the foundational thesis that talent must not require an existing audience to become discoverable. We decouple capability evaluation from popularity metrics, establishing a structured, objective merit layer.

| Why Existing Platforms Fall Short

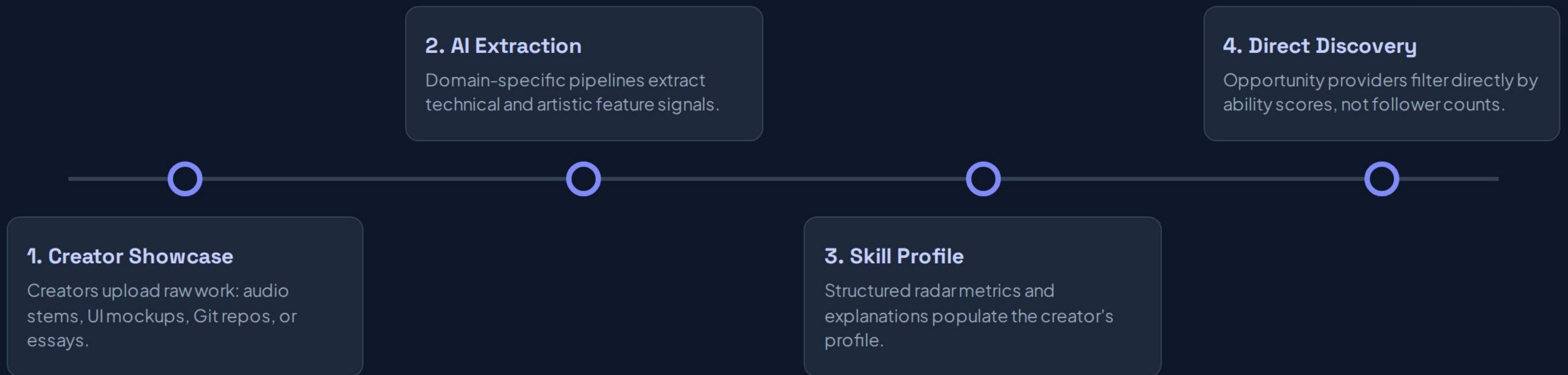
Platform	Primary Discovery Gate	Skill Assessment Mechanism	Structural Limitation
Instagram / TikTok	Follower count & viral video engagement	None (Subjective audience vanity metrics)	Incentivizes entertainment virality over actual skill
LinkedIn	Past company pedigree & alumni networks	Self-reported claims & peer endorsements	Favors Tier-1 pedigree; overlooks raw demonstration
Upwork / Fiverr	Historical client reviews & bid pricing	Completed job ratings on platform	High cold-start penalty for new student creators
Foundly (Proposed)	AI-Assisted Skill Intelligence	Multi-dimensional, work-based signals	Direct ability discovery without follower bias

💡 THE CORE INNOVATION

The Foundly Solution

Transforming raw, demonstrated work into structured, multi-dimensional skill intelligence—allowing opportunity providers to discover talent on merit alone.

| The Proposed Product Engine



| AI Skill Intelligence Dimensions

Category-Specific Modeling

Foundly rejects generic scores. Assessment models must reflect the nuanced parameters of specific disciplines:

Vocal Artists: Pitch accuracy, tone quality, dynamic expression, originality.

UI/UX Designers: Visual hierarchy, typography, composition, user flow.

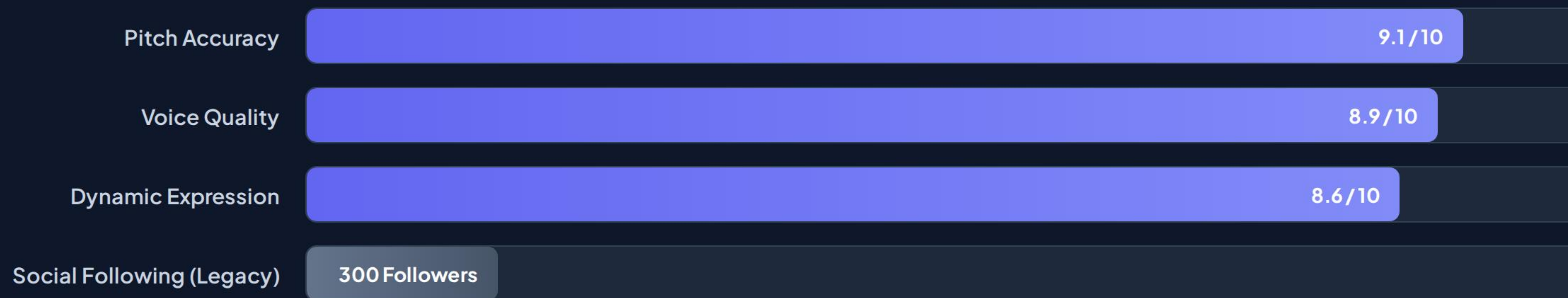
Software Developers: Architecture modularity, code efficiency, problem solving.

Signals, Never Absolute Judgments

Our core philosophy: *AI-generated scores are discovery signals and constructive feedback, not absolute verdicts on human potential.*

Scores serve as objective search indexes to bring overlooked talent to the surface, accompanied by granular explanations, confidence intervals, and human appeal pathways.

| Ability-Based Discovery in Action



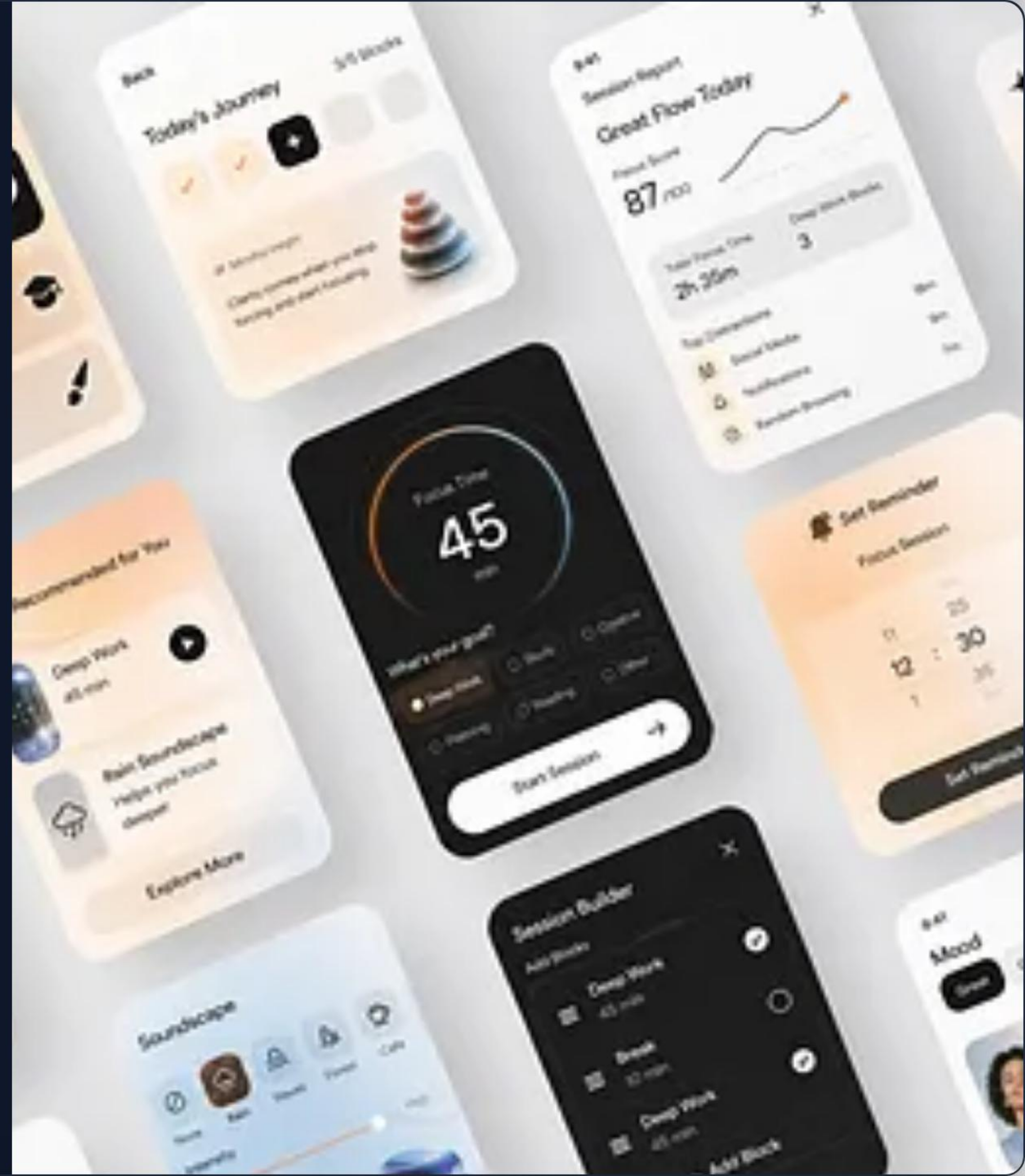
***Illustrative Prototype Scenario:** A music producer filters for $\text{Pitch} \geq 9.0$ and $\text{Voice Quality} \geq 8.5$. Rahul, a Tier-3 university singer with only 300 followers, ranks at the top of the ability search—bypassing traditional popularity gatekeepers.*

| Early Prototype Experience

Foundly's working prototype validates user flows across mobile and web interfaces.

Creators publish video and media directly into a curated feed, where background workers generate multi-dimensional skill radar cards.

**Note: Display reflects early TRL-3 prototype interface and illustrative evaluation outputs.*



| Target Stakeholders & Beneficiaries

Emerging Creators (Supply)

Primary Focus: College students, aspiring musicians, self-taught designers, and independent software developers—specifically across Tier-2/3 innovation hubs.

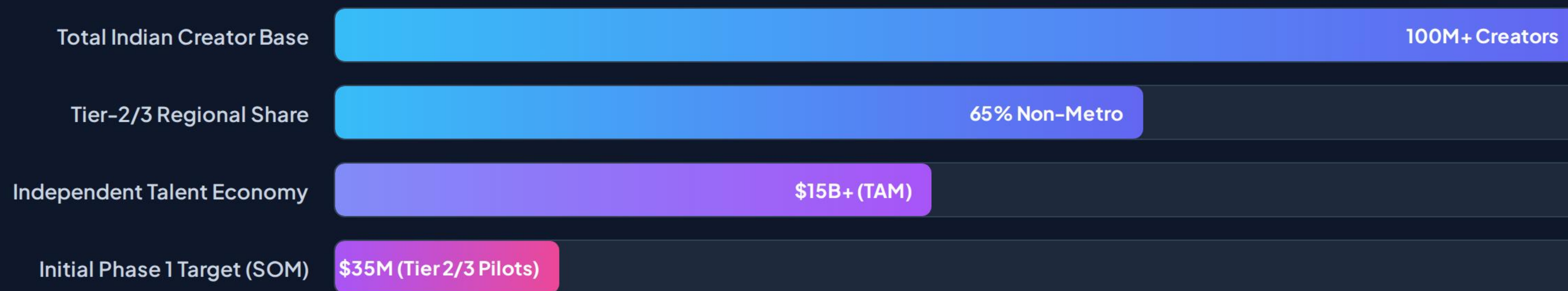
Value Proposition: Obtain merit-based visibility, receive constructive AI feedback, and build a verified skill profile that speaks louder than follower counts.

Opportunity Providers (Demand)

Primary Focus: Early-stage startups, boutique design studios, indie record labels, creative agencies, and agile engineering teams.

Value Proposition: Cut sourcing time by 70%, eliminate algorithmic bias, and discover high-caliber, cost-effective talent based on demonstrated execution.

| Market Opportunity in India



Sources: MeitY Digital India Reports & NITI Aayog Talent Studies (2024–2025). Over 65% of India's emerging creative talent originates from Tier-2 and Tier-3 towns, representing an immense, underserved demographic for ability-based discovery.

| Competitive Landscape Matrix

Capability Dimension	Social Networks (Insta/X)	Career Sites (LinkedIn)	Freelance Hubs (Upwork)	FOUNDLY (Proposed)
Social Showcase Layer	Primary Focus	Moderate / Professional	Absent	Core Foundation
Skill Feature Extraction	None	None (Self-reported)	Basic skill tags	Automated Domain AI
Ability-Filtered Search	No (Virality based)	Keyword / Title only	Rating / Hourly rate	Granular Skill Signals
Anti-Popularity Bias	Very Low (Viral priority)	Low (Pedigree priority)	Low (Rating priority)	High (Merit-First)

| Technology & Responsible AI



Multi-Modal Feature Extraction: Modular pipeline ingesting audio (pitch/timbre spectra), imagery (contrast/composition), and code repositories (AST parsing and complexity indexing).



Mitigating Model Bias: Explicit calibration against diverse Indian cultural accents, artistic idioms, and non-standard development practices to ensure fair scoring across regions.



Anti-Gaming & Provenance: Algorithmic watermarking and anomaly detection to identify synthetic or plagiarized work, safeguarding platform integrity.



Human-in-the-Loop Safeguards: Transparent confidence intervals, explainable score breakdowns, and human appeal pathways to prevent algorithmic disqualification.

| Proposed Business Model & Scale

Proposed Monetization Paths

Opportunity Providers (Primary): Tiered SaaS subscription for talent seekers to access advanced multi-dimensional filtering, verified candidate shortlists, and direct outreach credits.

Creators (Freemium): Free showcase & discovery; optional premium tier for advanced AI skill diagnostics, developmental feedback, and portfolio tools.

Compounding Flywheel

- 1. Work Ingestion:** More creators showcase verified work →
- 2. Intelligence Enrichment:** AI models generate denser, high-fidelity skill maps →
- 3. Provider Influx:** Attracts recruiters seeking precision talent →
- 4. Opportunities:** Delivers contracts and jobs, driving organic creator acquisition without ad spend.

| GTM & 9-Step Validation Plan

 **Phase 1 — Focused Beachhead:** Partner with university cultural societies, coding clubs, and design academies in Tier-2/3 academic corridors (e.g., Jaipur, Mohali, Coimbatore).

 **Phase 2 — Dual-Sided Pilot Validation:** Onboard 250 verified creators and 25 hiring partners across two focused verticals (e.g., vocalists and frontend engineers).

 **Phase 3 — Expert Benchmark Calibration:** Blind-test AI skill outputs against assessments from seasoned creative directors and engineering leads to validate signal reliability.

 **Key Metric Milestones:** Profile completion rate, AI insight engagement, search query satisfaction, and interview connection conversion.

| 12-Month Plan & Grant Allocation

Residency Quarter	Milestones & Technical Deliverables	GENESIS EIR Allocation (₹10 Lakhs Total)
Q1 (Months 1–3)	Complete creator user research; develop audio/code feature extraction pipelines; prototype testing.	₹2,50,000 (25%) — Prototyping tools & compute
Q2 (Months 4–6)	Deploy working MVP; implement multi-dimensional skill radar UI; launch university pilot cohort.	₹2,50,000 (25%) — MVP dev & cloud hosting
Q3 (Months 7–9)	Onboard 25 boutique opportunity providers; run expert benchmark calibration; test bias mitigation.	₹2,50,000 (25%) — Pilot testing & validation
Q4 (Months 10–12)	Consolidate pilot telemetry; optimize ranking models; prepare for follow-on MeitY Pilot Support.	₹2,50,000 (25%) — Compliance, IP & field trials

 DEMOCRATIZING DIGITAL OPPORTUNITY

Beyond Followers. Beyond Connections.

Foundly aims to make demonstrated ability a stronger signal for opportunity discovery—unlocking high-potential talent across India through responsible AI.

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